HHH-V-002131(Army-GL)
September 20, 1982

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PEAS, THERMOSTABILIZED, TRAY PACK

This interim Federal specification was developed by the U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Laboratories, Natick, MA 01760, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers peas, thermostabilized in tray pack cans for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

TT-C-495	-	Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal specifications, standards, and commercial item descriptions as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions. The index, which includes cumulative bimonthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification, and other Federal specifications, and commercial item descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston, MA; New York, NY; Philadelphia, PA; Washington, DC; Atlanta, GA; Chicago, IL; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth, TX; Houston, TX; Denver, CO; San Francisco, CA; Los Angeles, CA; and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal standardization documents, and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards and Commercial Item Descriptions from established distribution points in their agencies.)

FSC 8915

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Military Specification:

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence Items; General Specification for

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-900 - Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks and Sugars used in the Preparation of Canned Foods for the Armed Forces

(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Laws and Regulations:

U.S. Department of Health and Human Services

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR parts 100-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Food Quality Assurance Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture. Washington, DC 20250.)

U.S. Standard for Grades of Canned Peas (7 CFR 2852)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Information Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

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National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3, 6.1, and 6.4).

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Peas. The fresh or frozen peas shall be a single, sweet, wrinkled variety that is suitable for canning.

3.2.2 Salt. The salt shall be white, refined sodium chloride with a minimum purity of 99.9 percent. Iodized salt shall not be used.

3.2.3 Sugar. Sugar shall be white, refined, granulated cane or beet sugar or a combination thereof. It shall meet the bacterial requirements of MIL-STD-900.

3.3 Brine preparation. The brine shall consist of 12 pounds of sodium chloride and 18 pounds of sugar per 100 gallons of brine.

3.4 Tray pack filling and sealing. Each tray pack can (see 5.1.1) shall be filled with blanched peas and brine such as to conform to the following requirements:

(a) The temperature of the brine at time of filling shall be 190°F.

(b) The average net weight per can shall be 106 ounces minimum.

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(c) No individual can shall contain less than 104 ounces of product.

(d) No individual can shall contain less than 71 ounces of drained peas.

(e) The cans shall be hermetically sealed immediately after filling.

3.5 Tray pack thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed tray pack can shall be thermostabilized by retorting at 250°F or a lower temperature for such period of time as is necessary to provide a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6.0.

3.6 Finished food. The finished food shall be US Grade A in accordance with the United States Standards for Grades of Canned Peas as promulgated by the US Department of Agriculture.

3.7 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed, and packaged under modern sanitary conditions and in accordance with good manufacturing practice. The product shall be processed in establishments meeting the sanitary requirements of the applicable government inspection agency.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and acceptance service. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of acceptance service necessary to assure compliance to the requirements of this specification. The cost of grading and acceptance services performed by the USDA involving inspection, official documentation, and related services shall be borne by the contractor.

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be tested for the characteristic specified in 4.8. The presence of any defect or failure of any test shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.4 Component and material inspection. Components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

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4.5 Ingredient examination. Conformance of ingredients to identity and condition requirements shall be determined by examination of pertinent labels, markings, invoices, certificates of analysis, or other valid documents. In addition each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically as necessary to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity or condition requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient lot or any involved product.

4.6 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the ingredient preparation, product processing, and vacuum sealing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.7 Tray pack inspection. The inspection lot shall include only tray packs produced in one workshift. The Government reserves the right to separate the inspection lot into smaller inspection lots.

4.8 Net weight inspection. Randomly select 30 filled and sealed tray pack cans from the inspection lot and weigh separately. Subtract the average tare weight (determined by randomly selecting and weighing 30 empty tray pack cans and lids and dividing the total weight by 30) from the weight of each tray pack in the sample. If the average net weight is less than 106 ounces or if the net weight of any individual can is less than 104 ounces, the lot shall be rejected. Determine net weight to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

4.9 Product inspection. The finished product shall be inspected for conformance to the grade in accordance with the provisions of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Canned Peas.

4.10 Can external condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed tray pack cans shall be in accordance with the U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers.

4.11 Shipping container examination. When shipping containers are required to be in accordance with PPP-B-636, examination for defects in construction, closure and reinforcement shall be in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows: Major: National stock number, item description, contract number or date of pack markings missing, incorrect or illegible. Minor: (1) Other required markings missing, incorrect or illegible; (2) Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified; (3) When applicable, reinforcement with nonmetallic strapping or tape is not used. Level C shipping containers shall be examined only for the marking defects heretofore specified.

4.12 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. A size 1001 by 1206 by 200 tray pack can shall be filled with 106 ounces of food product, sealed, and thermoprocessed as specified in 3.4 and 3.5. The base plate of the can shall be electrolytic chromium-coated steel and shall be of sufficient weight and temper to protect the product during shipment and storage. The entire inside area of the can shall be coated. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I of TT-C-495.

5.1.2 Level C. The product shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1. except that cans with commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

5.2 Packing. The product shall be packed in accordance with level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed, closed and reinforced in accordance with style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pads shall be full length and width less approximately 1/4 inch in each dimension. The box liner and pads shall be fabricated of grade V3c fiberboard.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.2.1 Nonmetallic reinforcement of shipping containers. When specified (see 6.1 and 6.3), the shipping container specified in 5.2.2 shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Four cans of product, packaged, as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to ensure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. The shipping container shall be in accordance with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

5.2.3.1 Alternate level C packing. When specified (see 6.1), four cans of product, packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, grade

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275 of PPP-B-636. The cans shall be packed flat, four in depth within the box. The inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner and five fiberboard pads. The pads shall be placed between the cans and on the top and bottom of the stacked cans. The pads shall be full length and width less approximately 1/4 inch in each dimension and be fabricated of class domestic fiberboard.

5.3 Unit loads. When specified (see 6.1), the product, packed as specified in 5.2, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified. For distribution to Navy, when unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

5.4 Labeling. Each tray can shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497. Paper labels are not permitted. Tray cans shall show the following heating directions and yield.

TO HEAT

a. To Heat in Water: Submerge unopened tray can in boiling water. Simmer gently 15 minutes. Remove from water and open lid for serving.

b. To Heat in Oven: Either punch several holes in lid of tray can, or open can in usual manner leaving the loose lid in place to prevent moisture loss. Place in 350°F oven for approximately 15 minutes until contents reach an internal temperature of 165°F. Warning. Do not place closed can in oven as heating will increase internal pressure which may cause the can to burst.

YIELD

25 servings approximately 3 oz. each

5.5 Marking.

5.5.1 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.5.2 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(c) When nonmetallic reinforcement is required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).

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(d) When alternate (special requirements) level C packing is needed (see 5.2.3.1).
(e) Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.3).

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.3 Selection of nonmetallic reinforcement. The nonmetallic reinforcement specified in 5.2.2.1 should be selected for shipping containers that are destined for transfer at sea or other specific overseas operations.

6.4 First article. When a first article sample is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of DAR 7-104.55. The first article should be a preproduction sample consisting of three tray pack cans. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8915-A646

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER *(Number)* AND TITLE

HHH-V-002131(Army-GL) Peas, Thermostabilized, Tray Pack

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS OF SUBMITTER

☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER

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